

Research Methodology Document

Objective

The objective of this assignment was to identify and evaluate Federer-fit manufacturing companies aligned with DeepThought's ICP (Ideal Customer Profile) framework.

Selected Scope

- City Chosen: Bengaluru

- Industry Segments Chosen:

- Specialty Biotech
- Medical Devices
- Specialty Agri-inputs

The research focused on identifying technically differentiated, founder-driven manufacturers operating in growing sectors with visible operational and expansion signals.

Understanding of the Federer ICP

- Based on the assignment brief, a Federer-fit company was understood as:
- A company that manufactures differentiated technical products.
- Founder-led or technically led organization.
- Growth-oriented and actively expanding.
- Building in-house capability instead of outsourcing core functions.
- Operating in sectors with long-term growth tailwinds.
- Showing evidence of operational maturity, R&D focus, certifications, hiring activity, or facility expansion.

The assignment also required careful elimination of:

- Service-only firms
- CROs and testing labs
- Traders/distributors
- PE-controlled organizations
- Large conglomerate subsidiaries
- Generic commodity manufacturers
- Inactive companies

Research Sources Used

- LinkedIn

- Company Websites
- Google Search
- Tracxn / Tofler / Zaubacorp
- Industry Directories
- Startup India / Government Portals
- Press Releases & Interviews

Research Methodology

Step 1 — Building the Initial Company Pool

An initial list of companies was created using LinkedIn company search, Google search operators, startup databases, industry directories, and manufacturing news articles.

Step 2 — Initial Screening & Elimination

The initial list was filtered to remove:

- Non-manufacturing firms
- CROs and service-only biotech companies
- Generic SaaS/software companies
- Traders and distributors
- PE-controlled firms
- Inactive companies

Step 3 — Evaluation Against C1–C6 Criteria

Each shortlisted company was manually evaluated using the six Federer criteria:

- Manufacturing capability
- India-based operations
- Technical differentiation
- Technical founder or leadership
- Growing sector alignment
- Growth signals

Step 4 — Validation & Final Qualification

The shortlisted companies were cross-verified using company websites, founder profiles, press releases, hiring activity, certifications, and expansion announcements.

Key Evaluation Signals Used

- Proprietary technology or patents
- Scientist-led or engineer-led founders
- Deep-tech manufacturing capability
- Export activity
- Regulatory certifications
- Hiring activity

- Plant expansion
- R&D investment

Challenges Faced During Research

1. Distinguishing manufacturers from service companies
2. Limited financial information for private firms
3. Verifying in-house manufacturing
4. Identifying reliable growth signals
5. Separating differentiated firms from generic manufacturers

Key Learnings

The research highlighted that many Indian specialty manufacturers possess strong technical capabilities but limited public visibility.

Operational and growth indicators were often more useful than revenue data alone.

AI Usage Transparency

AI tools such as ChatGPT and Claude were used to assist with:

- Research structuring
- Summarization
- Search ideation
- Data organization
- Draft refinement

All company qualification decisions and evidence verification were manually reviewed.

Final Output

The final output includes:

1. Shortlisted company CSV
2. Criterion-wise evaluation
3. Supporting evidence
4. Federer scoring
5. Personalized outreach hooks

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